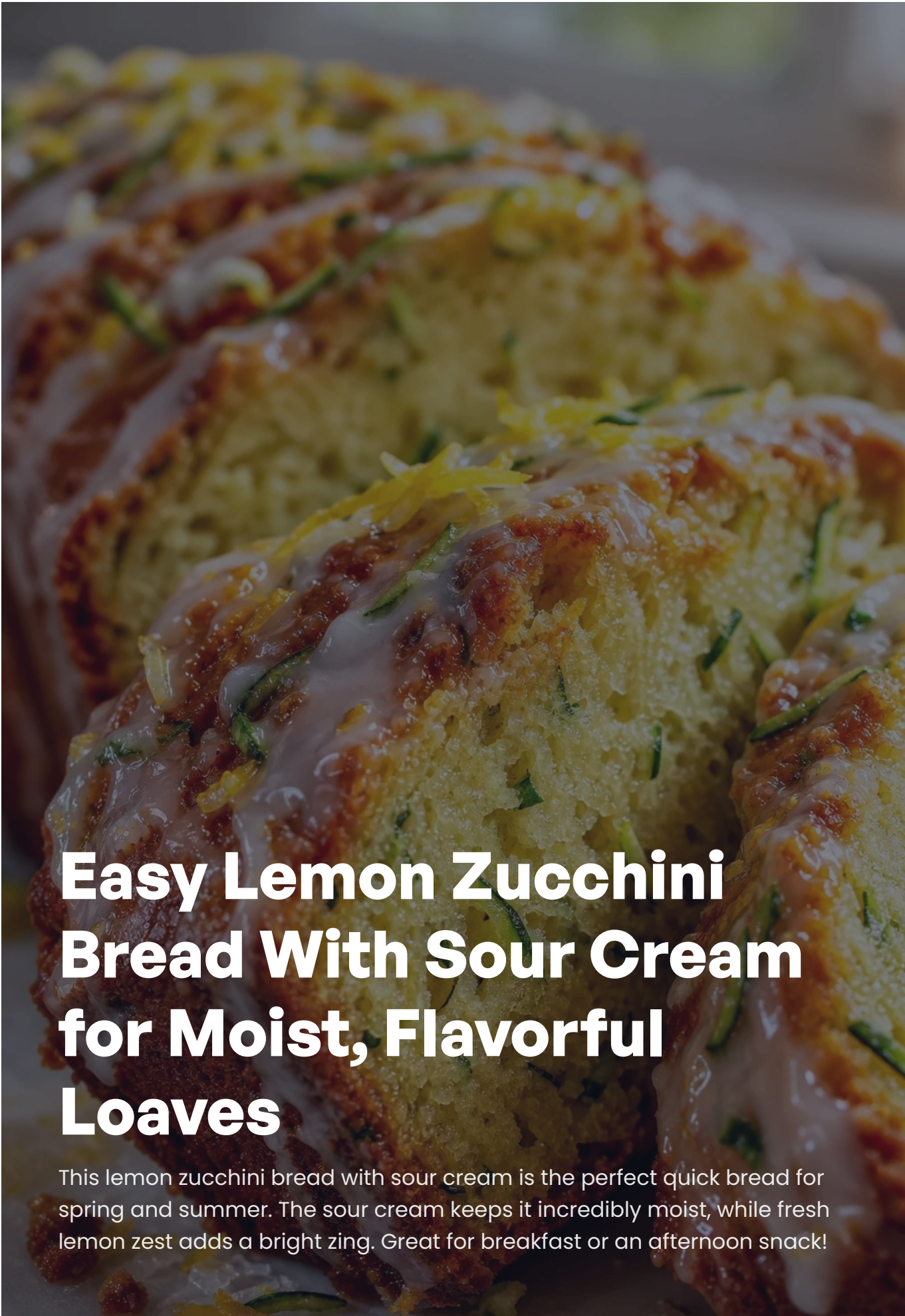




Easy Lemon Zucchini Bread With Sour Cream for Moist, Flavorful Loaves

This lemon zucchini bread with sour cream is the perfect quick bread for spring and summer. The sour cream keeps it incredibly moist, while fresh lemon zest adds a bright zing. Great for breakfast or an afternoon snack!



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15 min

PREP



50 min

COOK



65 min

TOTAL



8

SERVINGS



Easy

DIFFICULTY

Ingredients

- ☐ 2 cups all-purpose flour
- ☐ 1 teaspoon baking soda
- ☐ 1/2 teaspoon baking powder
- ☐ 1/4 teaspoon salt
- ☐ 1 tablespoon lemon zest (about 1 large lemon)
- ☐ 1 cup granulated sugar
- ☐ 1/2 cup vegetable oil

- ☐ 2 large eggs
- ☐ 1 teaspoon vanilla extract
- ☐ 1 cup sour cream
- ☐ 1 1/2 cups grated zucchini (about 1 medium zucchini)
- ☐ 2 tablespoons fresh lemon juice

Instructions

- 1** Preheat your oven to 350°F (175°C) and grease a 9x5 inch loaf pan or line it with parchment paper. This step ensures your bread won't stick and will bake evenly. Using parchment paper also makes for easy removal and cleanup. Make sure the oven is fully preheated before baking to get a nice rise and golden crust. ⌚ 10 minutes
- 2** In a medium bowl, whisk together the flour, baking soda, baking powder, salt, and lemon zest. Combining these dry ingredients well distributes the leavening agents evenly, which is essential for a uniform rise and crumb texture. The lemon zest in the dry mix helps release its oils gradually during baking, infusing the bread with bright citrus flavor. ⌚ 5 minutes
- 3** In a large bowl, beat the sugar, oil, eggs, and vanilla extract until smooth and creamy. This mixture forms the base of your batter and helps incorporate air for a lighter texture. Beating well ensures the sugar dissolves and the eggs emulsify with the oil, which contributes to a tender crumb. ⌚ 3-5 minutes
- 4** Add the sour cream and lemon juice to the wet mixture and stir gently until combined. The sour cream adds moisture and a slight tang that balances the sweetness, while the lemon juice brightens the flavor. Mixing gently here prevents overworking the batter, which could make the bread dense. ⌚ 2 minutes
- 5** Fold the dry ingredients into the wet ingredients carefully, mixing just until no flour streaks remain. Overmixing can develop gluten and make the bread tough, so be gentle and stop as soon as combined. The batter should be thick but pourable. ⌚ 3 minutes
- 6** Grate the zucchini finely, then place it in a clean kitchen towel and squeeze out excess moisture. This step prevents the bread from becoming soggy while keeping the zucchini's fresh flavor and texture. Fold the zucchini into the batter evenly. ⌚ 5 minutes
- 7** Pour the batter into the prepared loaf pan and spread it evenly. Tap the pan gently on the counter to release any large air bubbles. This helps the bread bake evenly and prevents large holes inside. ⌚ 2 minutes

- 8** Bake for 50–60 minutes, or until a toothpick inserted into the center comes out clean or with a few moist crumbs. Baking low and slow allows the loaf to cook through without drying out. If the top browns too quickly, tent with foil halfway through baking. ⌚ 50–60 minutes
- 9** Let the bread cool in the pan for 15 minutes, then transfer to a wire rack to cool completely. Cooling allows the crumb to set and prevents it from becoming gummy. Once cooled, you can optionally drizzle a simple lemon glaze for extra brightness. ⌚ 30 minutes

Chef Tips

☑ Always squeeze excess moisture from grated zucchini before adding to the batter. Removing excess water prevents the bread from becoming soggy and ensures the crumb has the right texture. Too much moisture can cause the bread to collapse or bake unevenly.

☑ Use fresh lemon zest and juice rather than bottled for the best flavor. Fresh lemon zest contains aromatic oils that give a bright, fresh flavor that bottled juice lacks. The acidity in fresh lemon juice also reacts better with baking soda to leaven the bread.

☑ Mix the batter just until the dry ingredients are incorporated. Overmixing develops gluten, which can make the bread tough and dense. Gentle folding keeps the crumb tender and light.

☑ Bake the bread in the center of the oven for even heat distribution. Placing the loaf in the center rack ensures even baking, preventing the edges from overcooking while the center remains underdone.

☑ Tent the bread with foil if it browns too quickly during baking. Foil protects the crust from burning while allowing the interior to finish baking, ensuring a moist crumb without a burnt top.

☑ Allow the bread to cool completely before slicing.

Cooling lets the crumb set firmly, making slicing cleaner and preventing the bread from crumbling or becoming gummy.

✂ Use a serrated knife to slice the bread gently.
A serrated knife cuts through the crust without compressing the soft crumb, preserving the bread's texture.

Storage & Reheating

❏ Refrigerator
Keep wrapped in an airtight container in the fridge for up to 5 days. The bread may firm up and lose some moisture, so warming slices slightly before serving helps restore softness.

❏ Freezer
Wrap the loaf tightly in plastic wrap and then foil, or slice and freeze in individual portions in airtight bags for up to 3 months. Thaw overnight in the fridge or at room temperature before reheating.

✂ Reheating
Warm slices gently in the microwave for 15-20 seconds or in a toaster oven at 300°F for 5-7 minutes. Avoid overheating which can dry out the bread. Adding a small pat of butter or a light drizzle of honey enhances flavor and moisture.

Nutrition (per serving)

280 kcal CALORIES	4g PROTEIN	38g CARBS
12g FAT	2g FIBER	210mg SODIUM

Nutritional values are estimates and may vary based on specific ingredients used.

Thank You

Thank you for choosing this recipe collection. We hope it brings warmth and flavor to your kitchen.



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